

B0B04B22 - Anglický jazyk B2-2

WEEK 3

FEL B2 Exam READING Part 1 (gap fill – grammar / vocabulary)
COMMUNICATION SKILLS: Defining / Explaining* / Summarizing**
Examining a Text for Facts (Main Ideas & Support)

In academic work students are often expected to provide **definitions and/or explanations*** of key words and phrases in order to demonstrate that they understand these terms clearly.

Summarizing** effectively is crucial in academic writing for demonstrating comprehension, building arguments, and avoiding plagiarism. It requires understanding the source material, identifying key ideas, and expressing them concisely in your own words. This skill is essential for successful academic work at the university level.

READING PART 1

For the Reading Part 1 section on the FEL B2 English exam you are required to fill in ten (10) individual gaps in a text with ONE single word per gap. You are not provided with multiple-choice options; you must rely on your grammar and vocabulary knowledge to determine the correct words. This part of the exam focuses on testing your understanding of grammar (e.g., articles, prepositions, auxiliary verbs, pronouns) and vocabulary (e.g., phrasal verbs, linking words).

This part of the exam tests grammar structures like:

- VERB FORMS (perfect, continuous and simple forms, modal verbs)
- PRONOUNS AND POSSESSIVES (myself, their, ourselves, yours, mine or relative pronouns who, what, that, which)
- COMPARATIVE FORMS (the + comparative, the + comparative; less + adjective than; the + superlative)
- ARTICLES (a, an, the)
- DETERMINERS (this, that, either, neither, all of)
- CONDITIONALS (the words "if" or "when" might be missing)
- QUANTIFIERS (some, many, a few, any, much)
- TIME CONJUNCTIONS (before, when, after, as soon as)

There are also questions about:

- NOUNS, VERBS, AND ADJECTIVES WITH PREPOSITIONS (advantage of, worried about, apologize for)
- FIXED PHRASES (every now and then, by chance, under no circumstances)
- PHRASAL VERBS (move away, pick up, take out, grow up)
- COLLOCATIONS (do homework, give advice, save time)

The instructions For the Reading Part 1 section on the FEL B2 English exam are as follows:

Complete the following text by filling in the proper word for each of the blank spaces (1 – 10).

Write **ONE WORD ONLY** in each space.

A company in (1) _____ USA has launched a chocolate powder that it says people can **snort** to get high. The product is based on the raw cocoa bean, which is (2) _____ chocolate comes from. It is called Coko Loko and the company claims it provides a drug-free energy "high". Coco Loko is manufactured by a company called Legal Lean. Its CEO Nick Anderson explained (3) _____ he came to market his product. He said he first heard about people snorting chocolate in Europe. He initially thought it was a **hoax**, but (4) _____ he tried it and realized that it had **commercial prospects**. Mr. Anderson told reporters that his company's chocolate product is, "probably equal (5) _____ about two energy drinks".

The powder is not **regulated** by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration. Many doctors are concerned (6) _____ whether the powder is safe. Toxicology expert Dr Jason Russell warned that the product had the same risk factors (7) _____ other energy **supplements**. He said (8) _____ was a risk of increased blood pressure, insomnia and increased heart rate. A medical website said it was concerned that the product does not have an official ingredients list, so users do not know what is in (9) _____. The website recommended that people eat chocolate instead of sniffing it to make sure they do not suffer (10) _____ health problems. Mr. Anderson said: "There are no health issues. It's been out for two, three years. Everyone seems fine."

DEFINING / EXPLAINING WORDS / PHRASES FROM A TEXT

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Academic English often requires users to provide a clear and unambiguous (straightforward) statement of what a word means. Statements should be communicated in the form of a complete sentence.

To define a word means to state its precise meaning, often in a concise way, like in a dictionary.

To explain a word involves providing a detailed explanation, potentially including how it is being used in a particular context, or its implications as used in a particular text.

Can you define / explain the words / phrases in **bold** from the text on the previous page?

[1] **SNORT**

[2] **HOAX**

[3] **COMMERCIAL PROSPECTS**

[4] **REGULATE**

[5] **SUPPLEMENTS**

Which of the definitions / explanations below (a - o) would be an appropriate way of communicating the meaning of the following words/phrases (1 - 5) in a classroom setting:

- ☒ 1) The word **snort**...
 - ☐ 2) A **hoax**...
 - ☐ 3) The phrase **commercial prospects**...
 - ☐ 4) If something is **regulated**...
 - ☐ 5) A **supplement**...
-
- a) ...is like sniff.
 - b) ...I have a harder time to do it.
 - c) ...is a plan to deceive, cheat or trick someone.
 - d) ...it might have some rules.
 - e) ...supplements something.
 - f) ...then that activity or process is controlled by rules or a system.
 - g) ...is a spam.
 - h) ...means to consume something by breathing it in quickly through the nose.
 - i) ...could mean inhale.
 - j) ...suggests that something has the potential for success and/or profit.
 - k) ...we use like a business phrase.
 - l) ...is something that is added to something else in order to improve it or complete it.
 - m) ...is a nose sound.
 - n) ...is a bad thing people do.
 - o) ...is something I drink at the fitness center.

SUMMARIZING A TEXT

In Academic English, summarizing involves condensing a larger text into a shorter version while retaining its core meaning and key points. It is an important skill for effectively communicating complex information and demonstrating comprehension of source material. Summaries should be concise, accurate, and in your own words,

What **BELONGS** in a summary:

- THE MAIN POINTS OF THE TEXT

What **DOES NOT BELONG** in a summary:

- YOUR OPINION ABOUT THE TEXT
- YOUR ANALYSIS OF WHAT IS MEANT BY WHAT YOU READ IN THE TEXT
- EVERY NAME MENTIONED IN THE TEXT
- ALL OF THE NUMBERS / DATES / STATISTICS MENTIONED IN THE TEXT
- THINGS THAT ARE NOT MENTIONED IN THE TEXT

The Difference Between Summary and Paraphrase

Parameter of comparison	SUMMARY	PARAPHRASE
Meaning	A summary is a clear statement that gives the key details of a particular topic.	A paraphrase is rewording a previously composed passage into simpler or shorter words that makes the meaning of the words much more clear.
Nature	Summarizing involves a writer composing only the key details on his article/text in his own words.	Paraphrasing involves an individual rewording any particular article/text in his/her own words.
Length	A summary is generally concise when compared to the original text/article.	A paraphrase is generally longer or equivalent to the original text/article.
Purpose	Summarizing is undergone to write down only the "bullet points" to condense the text without any explanation required on the text/article.	Paraphrasing is undergone to simplify/clarify the original text/article.
Selectivity	A summary will often leave out certain thoughts/views from the original passage if it does not concern the main motive/objective of the original, provided that the erasure does not change the overall meaning of the passage.	A paraphrase ought to be precise when it comes to containing all the details of the article since a paraphrase usually considers a detailed portion of an essay.

→ If you are asked to give a SUMMARY... **DO NOT** PARAPHRASE (it is NOT the same thing)

EXAMINING A TEXT FOR THE FACTS ('Asking the Journalist's Questions')

When examining a text, regardless of how long or short, one of the most important tasks is to find the facts contained within it. Another key task is determining which of the facts and details offered in the text are important to the overall understanding of the main point the text is attempting to communicate to the reader. Perhaps the best way to analyze a text is by using what are called *The Journalist's Questions*:

EXAMPLES:

WHO:	WHO was mentioned? WHO was affected?
WHAT:	WHAT is the overall topic? WHAT is the significance of the topic? WHAT are the issues / WHAT is the basic problem?
WHERE:	WHERE did the action of the text take place? WHERE are the main places affected by the problem or issue? WHERE does the problem or issue have its source?
WHEN:	WHEN did the research / study / action of the text take place? WHEN did the issue or problem develop? WHEN did / will the issue / problem reach its high point?
WHY:	WHY did the issue or problem arise? WHY is it (the topic) an issue or problem at all? WHY did the issue or problem develop in the way that it did?
HOW:	HOW is the issue or problem significant? HOW is it being addressed? HOW does it affect the participants? HOW can the issue or problem be resolved?

POSSIBLE FOLLOW-UP QUESTIONS:

(WHAT role did they play?) (HOW were these people affected?)
(WHY is it significant?) (WHY are they important / problematic?)
(HOW or WHY is/was it being studied?) (Was it in the past? present? future?)

Look at the following WHO, WHAT, WHERE, WHEN, WHY & HOW questions and answers designed to help you with THE FACTS of the text on Page 1.

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HOWEVER, not all of these "facts" are important to the overall understanding of the text or its main point.

Go through "the facts" below, and decide which (e.g., the **Top 3 [MAX 5]**) are → *Some 'facts' may actually be the most important to the overall understanding of the text or its main point.* *DETAIL/EXAMPLE SENTENCES for SUPPORTING SENTENCES already given.*

(1) WHAT does the text say is happening?

A company is producing a chocolate powder that can get you high.

(2) WHERE is this happening?

In the USA.

(3) HOW do people ingest / consume this product?

They snort it. → *WHAT does "snort" mean? How would you explain it in English if you have not already done so?*

(4) WHAT is the product based on?

Raw cocoa beans.

(5) WHAT is the name of the product?

Coko Loko.

(6) WHAT is the name of the company that makes the product?

Legal Lean

(7) WHAT is the CEO's name?

Nick Anderson.

(8) WHERE did the CEO say he first heard about people doing the activity?

Europe.

(9) HOW did the CEO feel about what people were doing at first?

He thought was a hoax. → *WHAT is a "hoax"? How would you explain it in English if you have not already done so?*

(10) WHAT did the CEO realize about the product?

It had commercial prospects. → *WHAT are "commercial prospects"? How would you explain it in English . . . ?*

(11) WHAT other product is this new product similar to?

Energy drinks.

(12) HOW many of this other product is the new product equal to?

About two.

(13) WHY are many doctors concerned about the product?

It might not be safe.

(14) WHO is Dr Jason Russell?

A toxicology expert.

(15) WHAT was the product likened to regarding risk?

Energy supplements. → *WHAT are "supplements"? How would you explain it in English . . . ?*

(16) WHY are the things the product was likened to dangerous?

Risks = increased blood pressure, insomnia and increased heart rate.

(17) WHAT kind of list does the product not officially have?

An ingredients list.

(18) WHAT recommendations regarding the issue / problem are mentioned?

People should eat chocolate instead of sniffing it.

(19) WHO made the recommendations?

A medical website.

(20) WHEN did the events in the text take place?

UNKNOWN

REMEMBER...

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When summarizing what you have read, especially in an academic context or setting, facts should always take precedence over opinions – this means that one should clarify exactly what the MAIN IDEA of the text is about **before** discussing other things such as offering an opinion, agreeing or disagreeing with any or all details, and/or stating what one “thinks it *might* have meant.”

EXAMPLE: “The text was about a company (in the USA) which is producing a chocolate powder that can get people high. Despite the fact that some doctors think it might not be safe (and the fact that it does not have an ingredients list), people are snorting, or consuming this new product (called Coko Loko) by breathing it in through their noses.”

FOLLOW-UP info in red = SUPPLEMENTARY, but NOT IMPORTANT to the overall understanding of the text or its main point.

ANYTHING NOT MENTIONED = NOT IMPORTANT TO THE OVERALL UNDERSTANDING OF THE TEXT OR ITS MAIN POINT.

⚡ STILL REQUIRES COMMUNICATION SKILLS



CLASSROOM DISCUSSION (on the general theme of the text)

At this point, a classroom discussion of the text can/may begin – which could include any or all of the remaining INFORMATION (including speculation and/or guessing about things NOT MENTIONED directly in the text itself [e.g., *When MIGHT the events in the text have taken place?*]).

Any discussion of the topic may also include general thoughts about things relating to (directly or indirectly) what was mentioned in the text.

ALWAYS GIVE REASONS / SUPPORT / EXAMPLES FOR YOUR ANSWER(S) → NO ONE WORD ANSWERS...

EXAMPLE QUESTIONS FOR FURTHER DISCUSSION:

Have **you** ever heard of anyone snorting chocolate?

→ ...for example – if YES, then WHEN? WHERE?

– if NO, then No...and I think the whole idea of it is _____

...OR... No...and I think people who do it are _____

NOTE: These questions deal with YOUR opinion(s) and thoughts...

What do **you** think of chocolate?

→ “I (like, love, hate, am indifferent [to]) chocolate BECAUSE...”

...DO NOT answer for what “some people” “might” think or believe...

Does eating chocolate affect the way **you** feel?

...and there is really NO NEED to say things like ‘I think...’

Would **you** try the chocolate powder?

‘In my opinion...’ etc...

Why do **you** think that people feel they need a high?

Do **you** drink energy drinks?

VOCABULARY / WORD FORMATION

Complete the following sentences (1 - 15) by filling in the blank spaces with **the proper form of the word given for that sentence**. (ONE word per blank space: DO NOT add any words [e.g. prepositions]).

- (1) BREATHE A _____ atmosphere is one that is suitable for humans to breathe.
- (2) CHARACTERS All human behaviour may be _____ as being subject to drives aimed at achieving a goal in order to satisfy a need.
- (3) CONTRIBUTE He was awarded a prize for his _____ to world peace.
- (4) ENTHUSIASTIC The audience clapped _____ and called for more.
- (5) ESTIMATED In your _____, who's going to win?
- (6) EXPLAINING She gave a detailed _____ of the administration's health-care proposal.
- (7) EXPRESSED Her statement was a clear _____ of her views on this subject.
- (8) HONEST And the moral of the story is that _____ is always the best policy.
- (9) IMPROVE There's been a definite _____ in your English since you started these lessons.
- (10) OPTION Science and Maths are compulsory for all students, but English is _____.
- (11) POSSIBLE The forecast said that there's a _____ of snow tonight.
- (12) PROGRAMMED The use of computers or _____ logic controllers in systems which have a direct impact on safety obviously requires special care.
- (13) RESPOND I looked in her face for some _____, but she just stared at me blankly.
- (14) SPECIFIC Unless otherwise _____, all fields have a maximum length of 20 characters.
- (15) SUMMARY Can you _____ what it is that makes you think you would be suitable for this job?

PREPOSITIONS

Complete the following sentences (1 - 10) by filling in the blank spaces with the proper preposition. You may use ONLY ONE word for each blank space.

- (1) I think his career is more important _____ him than I am.
- (2) The judge reacted angrily _____ the suggestion that it had not been a fair trial.
- (3) The company is concentrating its resources _____ developing new products.
- (4) One of the aims of ethnography is to contribute _____ an understanding of the human race.
- (5) They valued Deanna's ability to empathize and connect _____ others.
- (6) If the Government wants to save the Pound it should start _____ strengthening the British economy.
- (7) Supermarkets are responding _____ increased consumer demand for organic products.
- (8) The festivities started _____ a procession through the town.
- (9) When pigeons can see the sun, they use it _____ their main means of direction finding.
- (10) The spoken word is actually a pretty inefficient means _____ communication, because it uses only one of your audience's five senses.